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SON RISE IN TAMIL NADU

In May, the 68-year-old M.K. Stalin—who had long waited in the wings of his illustrious father, M. Karunanidhi—led the DMK to victory in Tamil Nadu after a gap of a decade. Political observers had often predicted the DMK's return—as time passed, the AIDMK battled increasing anti-incumbency as well as the vacuum left after J. Jayalalithaa's passing—but Stalin's success also results from his attention to detail. Based on grassroots feedback curated by political strategist Prashant Kishor, Stalin developed a sustained and massive campaign with catchy slogans and promises like Rs 1,000 per month to every woman-headed household, a reservation of 75 per cent of jobs in industry for Tamils, an increase in reservations for women in government jobs to 40 per cent and the appointment of 215 people from various caste groups as priests in temples. Promises apart, he also put out a 'vision document' to spell out his priorities. Now, the challenge is for his government to deliver on these promises

PTI



HAIL TO THE CHIEF

In Assam, Himanta Biswa Sarma did the almost unthinkable—he unseated an incumbent chief minister who had just won an election, replacing Sarbanada Sonowal following the BJP's second consecutive win in the Assam Assembly elections. This was a reward for the former Congressman for being the chief architect of the saffron party's expansion in the northeast—it is now in power in six of eight states. Sarma's chief ministerial tenure has seen a blend of Hindutva narratives alongside welfare measures and the delivery of responsive governance. Some describe his loan waiver for rural women as a masterstroke